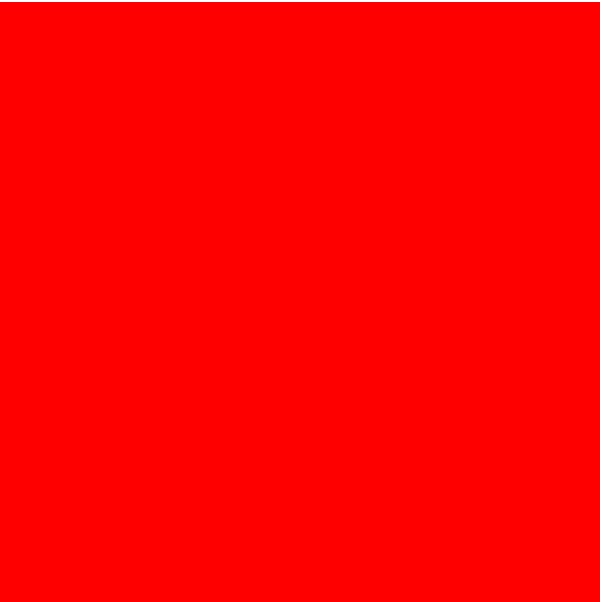SYNTHETIC